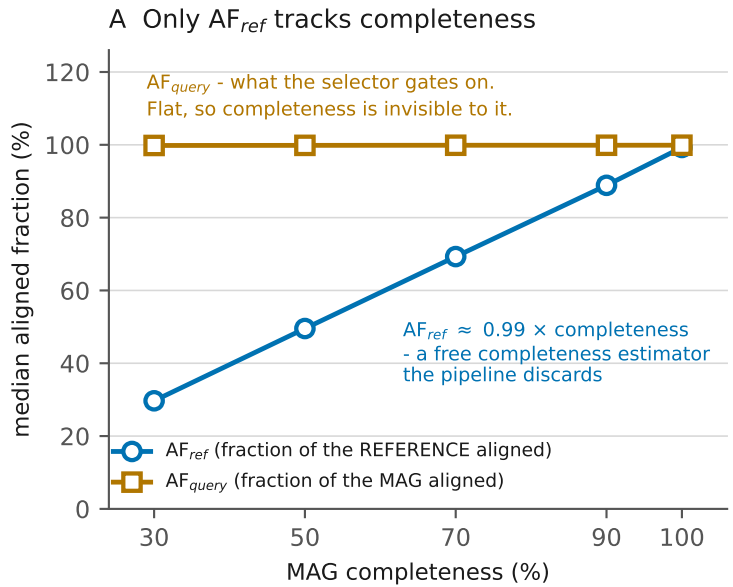
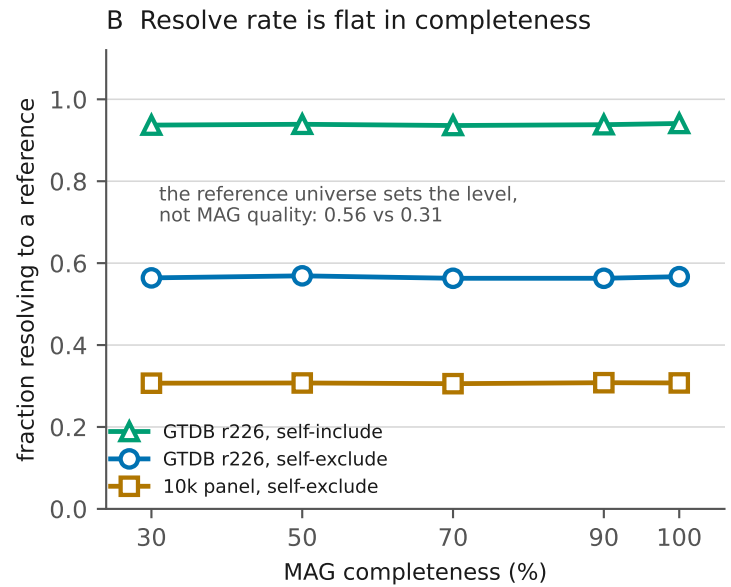
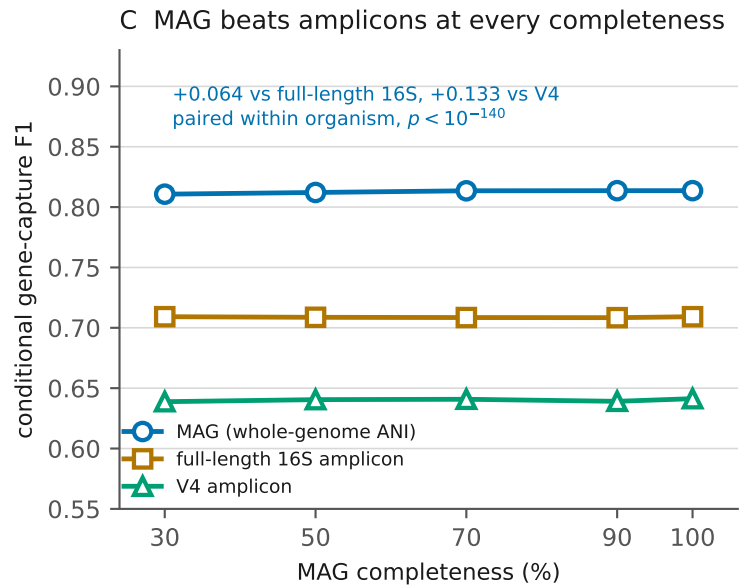
MAG reference selection is insensitive to completeness from 100% down to 30%







9,997 BV-BRC genomes x 5 completeness levels = 49,985 synthetic MAGs shown (panel B's GTDB series from a 1,000-genome subsample). Self-exclude removes the source genome, its taxon and every hit at >=95 ANI. Panel C is paired within organism against the 16S arm's own cells on the same genomes, n=1,510-1,573; it covers the 31% of organisms for which ANI finds a qualifying reference, which are also +0.06 easier for the 16S arm. Contaminated tiers are excluded throughout: the synthesizer's dose control fails at low completeness.